SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #113 · GRACE & WORKS

“Because of grace, my choices don’t matter.”

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Where it often comes from

Reacting against legalism by swinging to the other extreme. Hearing “God will forgive anyway” used to excuse sin. Wanting freedom without responsibility. Teaching that focused on grace but never on growth. Habits that are hard to change, so it feels easier to say they don’t matter.

What Scripture teaches

Grace is God’s free gift, and it never depends on our performance. But grace does not make our choices meaningless. Paul asked, “Shall we continue in sin so that grace may increase? Certainly not!” The grace of God teaches us to say no to ungodliness and to live upright lives. We are called to freedom, but not to use it for the flesh; rather, to serve one another in love. Grace saves us and also changes us.

> *“What then shall we say? Shall we continue in sin so that grace may increase? Certainly not! How can we who died to sin live in it any longer?”* **(Romans 6:1–2)**.

Also see

> “For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to everyone. It instructs us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live sensible, upright, and godly lives in the present age” **(Titus 2:11–12)**.

> “For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love” **(Galatians 5:13)**.

> “For sin shall not be your master, because you are not under law, but under grace” **(Romans 6:14)**.

> “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life” **(Ephesians 2:10)**.

Common self-statements

- God will forgive me anyway, so it doesn’t matter.
- Grace means I don’t have to change.
- My choices don’t affect my relationship with God.
- Obedience is legalism.
- I can live however I want.
- Sin doesn’t really hurt anyone.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must choose between grace and obedience.
- **Minimizing:** Downplaying the real harm sin causes.
- **Rationalizing:** Using grace as an excuse for choices you know are wrong.
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking Scripture’s teaching that grace trains us to live well.

Challenging questions

- How did Paul answer, “Shall we continue in sin so that grace may increase?”
- What does the grace of God teach us, according to Titus 2:12?
- What is freedom in Christ for, according to Galatians 5:13?
- Do my choices affect me and the people I love?
- Is grace something to presume on or something to respond to?
- What does Ephesians 2:10 say I was created for?
- What choice do I need to take more seriously?

Truth summary

> Grace is free, but my choices still matter. God’s grace saves me and also teaches me to say no to ungodliness and live a godly life. I am free in Christ, not to indulge the flesh but to serve others in love. My choices affect me, others, and my closeness with God, and grace gives me power to choose well.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Grace
- Obedience
- Sin, Consequences of
- Temptation
- Righteous

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Sin
- Temptation
- Backsliding

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Because of grace, my choices don't matter"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Because of grace, my choices don't matter." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How did Paul answer the question about sin and grace?
- ☐ What does God's grace teach me?
- ☐ What is my freedom for?
- ☐ Do my choices affect others?
- ☐ Am I presuming on grace or responding to it?
- ☐ What was I created to do?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Grace is free, and my choices still matter.
- ☐ God's grace teaches me to live a godly life.
- ☐ I am free to serve others in love.
- ☐ Sin is not my master; I am under grace.
- ☐ I was created for good works.
- ☐ Grace gives me power to choose well.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Romans 6:1–2**
  "What then shall we say? Shall we continue in sin so that grace may increase? Certainly not! How can we who died to sin live in it any longer?"
- [ ] **Titus 2:11–12**
  "For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to everyone. It instructs us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live sensible, upright, and godly lives in the present age."
- [ ] **Galatians 5:13**
  "For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love."
- [ ] **Romans 6:14**
  "For sin shall not be your master, because you are not under law, but under grace."
- [ ] **Ephesians 2:10**
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Grace in action log:** Each day, write one choice I made because of God's grace at work in me.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Titus 2:11–12 becomes: "For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to **Sarah**. It instructs **her** to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live a sensible, upright, and godly life in the present age."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grace" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Identify one choice you've been excusing with grace,** and take one step to change it this week.
- ☐ **Read Romans 6,** and write what it says about grace and the new life.
- ☐ **Ask a trusted believer to hold you accountable** in one area.
- ☐ **Do one act of love for someone** as a way of using your freedom well.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Because of grace, my choices don't matter": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One choice made by grace
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Because of grace, my choices don't matter.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for Your free grace. Help me reject the lie that because of grace my choices don't matter. Let Your grace train me to say no to ungodliness and to live for You. Use my freedom to serve others in love. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.